# 3-Tier Probing Framework

First Contact Resolution (FCR) On-the-Job Quick Reference Guide

DESKTOP JOB AID

**How to Use This Guide:** Apply this three-step probing sequence during billing or complex customer inquiries to de-escalate frustration, isolate root causes, and eliminate repeat calls.

| PROBING TIER | CORE OBJECTIVE | RECOMMENDED MASTER PHRASES |
|---|---|---|
| **Tier 1: Open Discovery**<br>⏱ First 30 Seconds | Uncover the customer's backstory and de-escalate emotion *before* searching system records. | • *"To help me pinpoint where that difference came from, what recent changes were made to your account?"*<br>• *"Walk me through what happened when you updated your service last month."* |
| **Tier 2: Targeted Diagnostic**<br>⏱ System Investigation | Isolate specific line items (one-time vs. recurring) and explain underlying billing rules clearly. | • *"Looking at your itemized statement, do you see a one-time activation fee or a partial-month prorated charge?"*<br>• *"Let's compare the recurring base rate against the temporary adjustment."* |
| **Tier 3: Closed Confirmation**<br>⏱ Pre-Call Close | Verify full understanding and ensure all root issues are resolved before ending the call. | • *"Does this breakdown clearly explain where that temporary $80 charge came from?"*<br>• *"Have we fully addressed the billing question you called about today?"* |

### ✅ DO (FCR Best Practices)

- Listen actively during the first 30 seconds without interrupting.
- Distinguish between one-time fees and permanent rate changes.
- Confirm complete understanding before closing the interaction.

### ❌ DON'T (Common Traps)

- **System-First Trap:** Rushing straight into lookup before de-escalating.
- **Premature Solution Trap:** Issuing a credit without finding the root cause.
- **Blame Shift:** Pointing out previous agent errors to the customer.